

Attn: Composers and Scholars

2027 Penn State NEW-MUSIC FESTIVAL AND SYMPOSIUM

CALL FOR PAPERS/PRESENTATIONS

August 1, 2026 – University Park, PA

Email contact: Baljinder Sekhon, Festival Director bss5477@psu.edu

VISIT FESTIVAL WEBSITE: <https://sites.psu.edu/pennstatecomposition/penn-state-international-new-music-festival-and-symposium/>

Papers/Presentations Online Submission Form: <https://forms.gle/Feo1k4mLCWS5ZiCp9>

SUBMISSION DEADLINE: Friday September 4, 2026 11:59pm EST

The Penn State University School of Music will be holding the 4th Biennial International New-Music Festival and Symposium March 18-20, 2027. The festival will consist of multiple concerts and research presentation sessions, featuring the work of composers and scholars selected through an international call for scores and research proposals. Selected composer participants will attend the festival in person, work with performers, network with other participants and within the Penn State community, and hear their compositions presented on a festival concert. Selected scholars will present a paper/presentation on any topic related to contemporary music. The festival concerts will feature performances by Penn State faculty and student performers, Penn State large ensembles, chamber ensembles, and guest performers. Composers can submit up to two works total and can select from 27 categories/genres for submission.

Participant Eligibility:

1. Composers and scholars of any nationality and age are encouraged to apply.
2. **Selected participants are expected to attend the festival in person.** The Penn State School of Music might be able to provide modest travel or lodging funding for selected participants who do not have access to funding assistance from institutions or other sources.*
3. Faculty and Students currently enrolled at Penn State are not eligible to submit compositions or research presentations through this call for scores/proposals.
4. A maximum of three Penn State alumni will be selected for the festival: one in each category of acoustic composition, electronic composition, and paper/presentation.
5. Requirements and submission procedures are outlined below.

*Living Music and the Penn State Composition and Technology programs will assist with travel arrangements to and from the airport in State College if needed and provide lodging discounts through Penn State where possible. Dr. Baljinder Sekhon will provide a formal invitation for those seeking financial assistance from their institution, if needed. Living Music will make every effort to provide home stays for student composers and scholars, but this is not guaranteed. Funding assistance we can provide is very modest, but we will do everything possible to make this an equitable opportunity.

PAPERS AND PRESENTATIONS

Papers/Presentations Eligibility:

- Papers/Presentations should be no longer than 20-25 minutes, with time remaining for questions.
- Presentation slots will not exceed 30 minutes.
- Any topic related to contemporary music is eligible (theory, musicology, ethnomusicology, composition, electronic music, interdisciplinary arts, philosophy, etc.).
- Research presentations can take the form of paper readings, PowerPoint presentations, or other lecture formats as appropriate.
- Selected presenters are expected to attend the symposium in person.

Paper/Presentation Submission Guidelines:

- Submissions will only be accepted online. No hard copy submissions will be accepted.
- Submission Deadline: September 4, 2026
- Each scholar may submit 1 paper/lecture for presentation.
- A submission should include a link to a 300-word abstract.
- Abstracts should include a list of technical requirements for the presentation.
- Abstracts can include links to supplemental materials, if needed.
- Abstracts should be uploaded to an online file sharing service and remain available until November 1, 2026.

PAPERS/PRESENTATIONS ONLINE SUBMISSION FORM: <https://forms.gle/Feo1k4mLCWS5ZiCp9>

For additional information, please email Dr. Baljinder Sekhon: bss5477@psu.edu

Selected scholars will be informed no later than October 19, 2026.
